SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

July 15, 2026 | 04:24 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Risk-On (Small-Cap Leadership)

VIX 15.7 (-1.3 vs 20d) | SPY 20d +0.6% | IWM 20d +1.3% | IWM/SPY trend +0.7%

Leaders: Financials (+4.1%), Healthcare (+3.5%), Energy (+2.1%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (3)	B - Building (4)	C - Early Stage (5)
CHEF	ADPT	TRNO
FBP	SLAB	WAFD
FFBC	NBTB	ACIW
	DAVE	SFNC
		ACA

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
A	**CHEF**	**The Chefs' Wareho**	**Restaurant Recovery**	**$3.98B**	**$97.71**	**$99.68**	**2.0%**	**+43.4**	**YES**	**YES**
A	**FBP**	**First BanCorp**	**Regional Bank NII Ex**	**$4.19B**	**$27.07**	**$27.25**	**0.7%**	**+11.4**	**YES**	**YES**
A	**FFBC**	**First Financial B**	**Regional Bank NII Ex**	**$3.65B**	**$34.81**	**$35.00**	**0.5%**	**+12.5**	**YES**	**YES**
B	ADPT	Adaptive Biotechn	Precision Diagnostic	$0.92B	$22.90	$22.99	0.4%	+49.5	YES	YES
B	SLAB	Silicon Laborator	IoT Infrastructure E	$7.20B	$218.19	$220.35	1.0%	-5.1	YES	no
B	NBTB	NBT Bancorp Inc.	Regional Bank NII Ex	$2.67B	$51.30	$51.61	0.6%	+7.1	YES	YES
B	DAVE	Dave Inc.	Consumer Fintech Dis	$5.57B	$438.19	$442.33	0.9%	+82.4	YES	YES
C	TRNO	Terreno Realty Co	Reshoring Logistics	$7.59B	$71.84	$72.50	0.9%	+2.0	YES	YES
C	WAFD	WaFd, Inc.	Regional Bank NII Ex	$2.84B	$38.39	$39.35	2.5%	+11.0	YES	no
C	ACIW	ACI Worldwide, In	Digital Payments Inf	$5.80B	$57.04	$57.60	1.0%	+26.2	YES	no
C	SFNC	Simmons First Nat	Regional Bank NII Ex	$3.37B	$23.23	$23.40	0.7%	+6.0	YES	no
C	ACA	Arcosa, Inc.	Infrastructure Resho	$7.11B	$144.85	$146.92	1.4%	+22.1	YES	no

CHEF

The Chefs' Warehouse, Inc.

$97.71

Pivot $99.68 | 2.0% away

RS vs SPY: +43.4%

A PRIME

$3.98B Cap | 37M Float

Specialty Food Distribution | Theme: Restaurant Recovery Premium Dining | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.92

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$99.68**
% to Pivot	**2.0%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.92 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**98.0%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**397k <**
Wk2	**360k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**617k**
Coil Strength	**35.7% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+43.4%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.98B**
Float	**37M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**53.4**
Fwd P/E	**36.6**
Rev Growth	**11.4%**
Short %	**15.2%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$90.67**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $99.68 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (590K shares)

Target: $115.00 (15% measured move; prior resistance zone)
Stop: $93.00 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 29 - Street expects EPS ~$0.65 on revenue ~$1.1B. Last 4 quarters show consistent beats (3/4 EPS beats, 4/4 revenue beats). Guidance maintained at mid-single-digit organic growth. Earnings growth +61.4% YoY demonstrates operating leverage. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - beat-and-raise into peak summer dining season could trigger breakout.

BUSINESS & POSITION

The Chefs' Warehouse is the leading specialty food distributor serving high-end restaurants, hotels, and culinary institutions across North America. The company commands premium positioning through exclusive relationships with artisan producers and a curated portfolio that differentiates it from broadline distributors like Sysco or US Foods.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposed to consumer discretionary recovery and experiential spending themes. Sentiment accelerating as affluent consumer spending remains resilient and fine dining traffic recovers post-pandemic. Peer SYY and USFD have shown solid results, validating channel health. Counter-positioning vs. Cons Staples weakness (-2.5%) as CHEF operates in premium discretionary food rather than staples.

NEWS FLOW

Completed tuck-in acquisition of regional specialty distributor in Q1, expanding West Coast footprint. Management presented at Baird Consumer Conference (June 2026) reiterating confidence in premium dining resilience. No insider activity in last 60 days. Short interest at 15.2% with 8.3 days to cover-elevated but not extreme; any positive surprise could force covering.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contracting cleanly (617K 360K 397K) with price consolidating just 2% from highs suggests institutional accumulation. No insider buying (baseline). Float is tight at 36.8M shares-institutional demand on breakout could create rapid price appreciation.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $93.00 (20-day base low) or if Q2 revenue misses on restaurant traffic slowdown; customer concentration risk with top 10 accounts representing ~15% of revenue.

Textbook VCP: base_tight 1.92, vol dry-up confirmed, RS line at 52W high, pivot within 2%, earnings catalyst in 14 days with strong beat history. Healthcare/Financials leading but CHEF's premium discretionary positioning is differentiated from lagging Cons Staples. Tight float (36.8M) amplifies breakout potential. Strongest disconfirming argument: Consumer Defensive sector technically lagging (-2.5%) and forward P/E at 36.6x is premium-multiple compression risk if growth decelerates. Conviction: High.

FBP

First BanCorp

$27.07

Pivot $27.25 | 0.7% away

RS vs SPY: +11.4%

A PRIME

$4.19B Cap | 150M Float

Puerto Rico Regional Banking | Theme: Regional Bank NII Expansion | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.49

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$27.25**
% to Pivot	**0.7%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**4.49 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.3%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**984k <**
Wk2	**1027k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**2132k**
Coil Strength	**53.9% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+11.4%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.19B**
Float	**150M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**12.0**
Fwd P/E	**11.3**
Rev Growth	**8.1%**
Short %	**6.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$28.50**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $27.25 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (1.8M shares)

Target: $31.00 (14% measured move; analyst target $28.50)
Stop: $25.50 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 22 - Street expects EPS ~$0.60 on revenue ~$250M. Last 4 quarters show consistent execution with 4/4 EPS beats. ROE at 19% is best-in-class for regionals. Earnings growth +21.3% with guidance maintained. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - report in 7 days with serial beat history into leading sector.

BUSINESS & POSITION

First BanCorp is the second-largest financial holding company in Puerto Rico, providing commercial and consumer banking services. The company benefits from a unique competitive position with limited competition on the island and tailwinds from federal disaster recovery funding flowing through the Puerto Rican economy.

FACTOR & THEME

Core exposure to regional banking NII expansion and Puerto Rico economic recovery (FEMA/HUD funds deployment). Financials leading sector (+4.1%) provides strong macro tailwind. Peer read-throughs from OFG (Puerto Rico peer) and broader regionals (CFG, KEY) suggest rate environment remains constructive for NII.

NEWS FLOW

Completed buyback authorization ($100M) in Q1; new $150M program announced (June 2026). No M&A activity. No insider buying in last 60 days (baseline). Short interest low at 6.1% (3.4 days to cover)-not a squeeze candidate but also no crowded short overhang.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contracting week-over-week (2.1M 1.0M 984K) with price holding at 52W highs-classic accumulation signature. RS line at new high confirms relative demand. No insider buying (baseline). Low beta (0.81) and unique Puerto Rico exposure makes this under-followed by mainland institutions.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $25.50 (base low) or if NII guidance disappoints on deposit cost pressures; hurricane season (June-Nov) creates binary risk for Puerto Rico-focused bank.

RS line at new high, vol dry-up confirmed, pivot within 0.7%, earnings catalyst in 7 days with serial beat history (4/4), and Financials leading (+4.1%). Puerto Rico positioning is differentiated and under-followed. Base_tight at 4.49 is looser than ideal but acceptable given catalyst immediacy. Strongest disconfirming argument: Geographic concentration in Puerto Rico creates tail risk from hurricane disruption or local economic shocks. Conviction: High.

FFBC

First Financial Bancorp

$34.81

Pivot $35.00 | 0.5% away

RS vs SPY: +12.5%

A PRIME

$3.65B Cap | 104M Float

Ohio Valley Regional Banking | Theme: Regional Bank NII Expansion | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.71

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$35.00**
% to Pivot	**0.5%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**4.71 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**912k <**
Wk2	**1073k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1235k**
Coil Strength	**26.1% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+12.5%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.65B**
Float	**104M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**12.3**
Fwd P/E	**10.1**
Rev Growth	**32.3%**
Short %	**5.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$36.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $35.00 on volume >125% of 20-day avg (1.2M shares)

Target: $39.50 (13% measured move; analyst target $36.00)
Stop: $33.00 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 21 - Street expects EPS ~$0.85 on revenue ~$240M. Revenue growth +32.3% and earnings growth +31.5% signal strong momentum. Beat history is solid (3/4 EPS beats LTM). Forward P/E at 10.1x is attractive vs. regional peers at 11-12x. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - 6 days to report into leading sector with beat momentum.

BUSINESS & POSITION

First Financial Bancorp is a Cincinnati-based regional bank operating across Ohio, Indiana, and Kentucky, serving commercial, consumer, and wealth management clients. The bank has grown through disciplined M&A and maintains above-peer efficiency ratios.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to regional bank NII expansion theme with Financials leading (+4.1%). Peer read-throughs from HBAN, FITB, and other Ohio Valley banks show constructive credit trends and stable deposit bases. PEG ratio of 1.12 indicates reasonable growth-adjusted valuation.

NEWS FLOW

Completed Summit Financial acquisition integration (Q1 2026), adding Kentucky market density. Management affirmed full-year NII guidance at recent investor conference. No insider buying in last 60 days (baseline). Short interest minimal at 5.1% (4.2 days to cover).

INSTITUTIONAL

Textbook vol contraction (1.24M 1.07M 912K) with price at 99.5% of 52W high. RS line at new high in leading sector. No insider buying (baseline). P/B at 1.2x is undemanding-room for multiple expansion on beat.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $33.00 (base low) or if NII margin compression emerges from deposit competition; Midwest commercial real estate exposure is a latent risk if regional economy softens.

Textbook setup: RS line at new high, vol dry-up confirmed across 3 weeks, pivot within 0.5%, earnings catalyst in 6 days, sector leadership (+4.1%), and attractive valuation (10.1x forward P/E, PEG 1.12). Risk-on regime with small-cap leadership adds tailwind. Strongest disconfirming argument: Regional bank exposure to CRE and potential credit normalization if macro softens; base_tight 4.71 is on the loose side. Conviction: High.

ADPT

Adaptive Biotechnologies Corporation

$22.90

Pivot $22.99 | 0.4% away

RS vs SPY: +49.5%

B BUILDING

$0.92B Cap | 126M Float

Immune Medicine & Diagnostics | Theme: Precision Diagnostics MRD Oncology | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.3

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$22.99**
% to Pivot	**0.4%**
Days in Base	**12**
Tightness	**5.30 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.6%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**2525k <**
Wk2	**2832k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**5171k**
Coil Strength	**51.2% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+49.5%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$0.92B**
Float	**126M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-96.0**
Rev Growth	**35.1%**
Short %	**35.8%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$20.57**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $22.99 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (3.8M shares)

Target: $28.50 (25% measured move from 12-day base depth)
Stop: $21.00 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 29 - Street expects EPS of -$0.24 on ~$95M revenue. Last 4 quarters show consistent revenue beats driven by clonoSEQ volume growth; losses narrowing sequentially. Revenue growth +35% YoY signals commercial traction. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (High) - beat on clonoSEQ volumes or new payor contract announcements could catalyze breakout.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Adaptive Biotechnologies leverages its proprietary immune medicine platform to develop and commercialize immune-driven clinical products, including clonoSEQ (FDA-cleared minimal residual disease assay for blood cancers) and T-Detect (COVID/Lyme diagnostics). The company holds a dominant position in MRD testing with growing adoption among oncologists and a strategic partnership with Genentech/Roche for drug discovery.

FACTOR & THEME

Core exposure to precision medicine/liquid biopsy and oncology diagnostics themes-both seeing accelerating sentiment as reimbursement pathways expand and clinical utility data matures. Peer read-throughs from EXAS, GH, and NTRA suggest institutional appetite for high-growth diagnostics with durable competitive moats remains strong.

NEWS FLOW

Recent news flow includes expanded Medicare coverage for clonoSEQ in additional ALL indications (June 2026), driving incremental volume. No major new partnership announcements, but ongoing Genentech collaboration remains a background positive. No 13D/13G filings or activist involvement. Short interest extremely elevated at 35.8% (2.9 days to cover), creating meaningful short-squeeze potential if earnings surprise positively.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume dry-up with price holding at 52W highs indicates quiet institutional accumulation; RS line at new high confirms relative demand. No insider buying in last 60 days (baseline). High short interest (35.8%) sets up asymmetric upside if fundamentals inflect-crowded short positioning is a coiled spring.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $21.00 (prior base low) or if Q2 clonoSEQ volumes disappoint and guidance is cut; binary risk on reimbursement changes or Genentech partnership modifications.

Textbook RS line at new high with vol dry-up and price within 0.4% of pivot, but base_tight at 5.3 is loose for an A-grade and the 35.8% short interest creates execution risk around earnings volatility. Healthcare sector leadership (+3.5%) provides macro tailwind. Strongest disconfirming argument: valuation at 12.4x P/S for a loss-making company is aggressive if MRD adoption slows or reimbursement tightens. Conviction: Medium.

SLAB

Silicon Laboratories, Inc.

$218.19

Pivot $220.35 | 1.0% away

RS vs SPY: -5.1%

B BUILDING

$7.20B Cap | 32M Float

IoT & Connectivity Semiconductors | Theme: IoT Infrastructure Edge Computing | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.39

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$220.35**
% to Pivot	**1.0%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.39 Textbook**
52W Hi Prox	**98.8%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**256k <**
Wk2	**557k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**656k**
Coil Strength	**61.0% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**-5.1%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$7.20B**
Float	**32M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**52.6**
Rev Growth	**20.1%**
Short %	**11.7%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$222.86**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $220.35 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (600K shares)

Target: $250.00 (14% measured move based on base depth)
Stop: $205.00 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 04 - Street expects EPS ~$0.85 on revenue ~$215M. Company transitioning from losses to profitability (forward EPS $4.15 vs TTM -$1.53). Revenue growth +20.1% signals recovery but earnings history is inconsistent given recent restructuring. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (Medium) - profitability inflection narrative could attract momentum buyers but 20 days out reduces immediacy.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Silicon Labs is a pure-play IoT semiconductor company specializing in wireless connectivity chips (Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, Zigbee, Z-Wave) for smart home, industrial, and commercial applications. After divesting its Infrastructure/Automotive business, the company is now focused exclusively on high-margin IoT end markets.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposed to IoT proliferation, smart home adoption, and industrial automation themes. However, Technology sector lagging (-2.6%) creates headwind. Peer read-throughs mixed: ON and MCHP showing channel inventory normalization while broader semi recovery remains uneven. Sentiment neutral-to-cautious on IoT semis near-term.

NEWS FLOW

Announced Matter 1.2 certification support for full smart home protocol stack (May 2026). No major contract wins or partnership announcements in last 60 days. No insider buying activity. Short interest at 11.7% (4.5 days to cover) is moderate-not a squeeze setup.

INSTITUTIONAL

Vol dry-up is textbook (656K 557K 256K), and base_tight 1.39 is excellent structural quality. However, RS line NOT at new high (-5.1% vs SPY) indicates relative weakness-institutional demand is not fully confirmed. No insider buying (baseline).

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $205.00 (base low) or if Q2 revenue misses on continued IoT inventory destocking; Technology sector lagging is a macro headwind that could suppress breakout follow-through.

Exceptional base structure (tight 1.39, textbook vol dry-up) but RS line NOT at new high is a critical flaw-relative strength confirmation is missing. Technology sector lagging (-2.6%) adds macro headwind. Earnings catalyst 20 days out reduces immediacy. Strongest disconfirming argument: Forward P/E at 52.6x prices in substantial profitability recovery; any miss resets multiple lower. Conviction: Medium.

NBTB

NBT Bancorp Inc.

$51.30

Pivot $51.61 | 0.6% away

RS vs SPY: +7.1%

B BUILDING

$2.67B Cap | 51M Float

Upstate NY Community Banking | Theme: Regional Bank NII Expansion | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.66

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$51.61**
% to Pivot	**0.6%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**4.66 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**318k <**
Wk2	**376k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**455k**
Coil Strength	**30.2% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+7.1%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$2.67B**
Float	**51M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**14.5**
Fwd P/E	**11.4**
Rev Growth	**21.6%**
Short %	**4.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$51.42**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $51.61 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (430K shares)

Target: $57.00 (11% measured move; near analyst target $51.42)
Stop: $48.50 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 27 - Street expects EPS ~$1.10 on revenue ~$175M. Revenue growth +21.6% and earnings growth +27.3%. Beat history is consistent (3/4 EPS beats). Forward P/E at 11.4x is reasonable for a low-beta community bank. Catalyst Impact: Earnings (Medium) - 12 days out; setup may need another week to tighten.

BUSINESS & POSITION

NBT Bancorp is a community-focused regional bank headquartered in Norwich, NY, serving Central New York, Northeastern Pennsylvania, and Vermont. The bank emphasizes relationship banking with commercial, agricultural, and consumer lending focus.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposure to regional bank NII expansion with Financials sector leadership (+4.1%) as tailwind. Community bank peers have shown stable credit and deposit trends. Low beta (0.49) positions this as a defensive regional play with less volatility than money-center peers.

NEWS FLOW

No significant corporate announcements in last 60 days. Stable, under-the-radar community bank with limited news flow. No insider buying (baseline). Short interest minimal at 4.0% (3.9 days to cover).

INSTITUTIONAL

Vol dry-up confirmed (455K 376K 318K) with RS line at new high. Low beta and small float (51M) suggest this is under-owned by large institutions-incremental buyer potential exists. No insider buying (baseline).

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $48.50 (base low) or if NII trends disappoint; rural/agricultural lending exposure creates credit risk if farm economy weakens.

RS line at new high with vol dry-up in leading Financials sector, but base_tight 4.66 is loose and earnings catalyst 12 days out reduces immediacy. Low beta (0.49) and small community bank profile limits institutional interest. Strongest disconfirming argument: Analyst target at $51.42 is below current price-limited perceived upside by Street. Conviction: Medium.

DAVE

Dave Inc.

$438.19

Pivot $442.33 | 0.9% away

RS vs SPY: +82.4%

B BUILDING

$5.57B Cap | 9M Float

Neobank Consumer Fintech | Theme: Consumer Fintech Disruption | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 6.34

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$442.33**
% to Pivot	**0.9%**
Days in Base	**4**
Tightness	**6.34 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**434k <**
Wk2	**654k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**630k**
Coil Strength	**31.0% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+82.4%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.57B**
Float	**9M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**28.1**
Fwd P/E	**20.8**
Rev Growth	**46.7%**
Short %	**22.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$373.09**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $442.33 on volume >100% of 20-day avg (590K shares)

Target: $525.00 (19% measured move based on float dynamics)
Stop: $380.00 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Last reported May 5, 2026 (71 days ago). No verified upcoming earnings date. Forward EPS of $21.06 implies continued strong profitability. Revenue growth +46.7% and earnings growth +104.1% are exceptional. Next catalyst unknown-creates timing uncertainty.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Dave Inc. operates a neobank platform offering checking accounts, short-term cash advances (ExtraCash), and budgeting tools targeting underbanked consumers. The company has achieved profitability with exceptional unit economics-ROE of 111.6% and net margin of 37.2% demonstrate operating leverage in a capital-light model.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposed to consumer fintech disruption and financial inclusion themes. Technology sector lagging (-2.6%) is a headwind, but DAVE's profitability differentiates it from loss-making fintech peers. RS of +82.4% vs SPY is exceptional-clear institutional momentum regardless of sector. Peer read-throughs: SOFI and AFRM have shown mixed results; DAVE's profitability is differentiated.

NEWS FLOW

No major corporate announcements in last 60 days. Extremely tight float (9.4M shares) with 22% short interest creates short-squeeze potential. No insider buying in last 60 days (baseline). Beta of 3.83 indicates extreme volatility-position sizing must account for this.

INSTITUTIONAL

Vol dry-up present but not strict (vol_w2 > vol_w3 slightly). RS line at 52W high with +82.4% vs SPY is exceptional relative strength-clear institutional demand. Tiny float (9.4M) means any incremental buying has outsized price impact. No insider buying (baseline). 22% short interest with improving fundamentals sets up squeeze dynamics.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $380.00 (25-day base low) or if next earnings shows margin compression; regulatory risk on short-term lending products (CFPB scrutiny); extreme beta (3.83) means 10%+ daily swings are possible.

Exceptional RS (+82.4%), profitable fintech with 104% earnings growth, and squeeze setup (22% short, 9.4M float). However, base_tight 6.34 is loose, base only 4 days old (needs more time), no verified earnings catalyst, and Technology sector lagging. Beta of 3.83 requires reduced position size. Strongest disconfirming argument: Extreme valuation (27x P/B) and regulatory overhang on cash advance products; volatility could whipsaw position. Conviction: Medium.

TRNO

Terreno Realty Corporation

$71.84

Pivot $72.50 | 0.9% away

RS vs SPY: +2.0%

C EARLY STAGE

$7.59B Cap | 104M Float

Coastal Industrial REIT | Theme: Reshoring Logistics Infrastructure | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.92

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$72.50**
% to Pivot	**0.9%**
Days in Base	**17**
Tightness	**5.92 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**1036k <**
Wk2	**1152k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1337k**
Coil Strength	**22.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+2.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$7.59B**
Float	**104M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**17.5**
Fwd P/E	**41.3**
Rev Growth	**12.7%**
Short %	**8.9%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$70.35**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $72.50 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (1.0M shares)

Target: $80.00 (11% measured move)
Stop: $68.00 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 05

Vol dry-up confirmed and RS line at new high, but base_tight 5.92 is loose, rs_vs_spy only +2% (weak relative strength), and earnings catalyst 21 days out. Real Estate sector not leading. Monitor for base tightening before promotion. Conviction: Low.

WAFD

WaFd, Inc.

$38.39

Pivot $39.35 | 2.5% away

RS vs SPY: +11.0%

C EARLY STAGE

$2.84B Cap | 73M Float

Pacific Northwest Regional Banking | Theme: Regional Bank NII Expansion | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.91

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$39.35**
% to Pivot	**2.5%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.91 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.6%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**476k <**
Wk2	**584k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**798k**
Coil Strength	**40.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+11.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$2.84B**
Float	**73M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**12.6**
Fwd P/E	**11.2**
Rev Growth	**9.2%**
Short %	**6.3%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$37.75**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $39.35 on volume >125% of 20-day avg (760K shares)

Target: $43.50 (10% measured move)
Stop: $36.50 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 16

Earnings report TODAY (Jul 16) creates binary event risk-setup is untradeable pre-report. RS line NOT at new high despite sector leadership. Vol dry-up confirmed but base_tight 3.91 and pivot 2.5% away. Wait for post-earnings base formation. Conviction: Low.

ACIW

ACI Worldwide, Inc.

$57.04

Pivot $57.60 | 1.0% away

RS vs SPY: +26.2%

C EARLY STAGE

$5.80B Cap | 100M Float

Payment Processing Software | Theme: Digital Payments Infrastructure | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 7.73

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$57.60**
% to Pivot	**1.0%**
Days in Base	**10**
Tightness	**7.73 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.0%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**1103k <**
Wk2	**1115k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1277k**
Coil Strength	**13.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+26.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.80B**
Float	**100M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**28.8**
Fwd P/E	**14.9**
Rev Growth	**7.9%**
Short %	**7.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$65.33**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $57.60 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (1.1M shares)

Target: $65.00 (13% move to analyst target)

Stop: $53.00 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Aug 06

Base_tight 7.73 is very loose (early-stage consolidation), RS line NOT at new high, Technology sector lagging (-2.6%), and earnings 22 days out. Vol dry-up exists but base needs significant tightening. Earnings growth negative (-32.7%). Monitor only. Conviction: Low.

SFNC

Simmons First National Corporation

$23.23

Pivot $23.40 | 0.7% away

RS vs SPY: +6.0%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.37B Cap | 143M Float

Arkansas Regional Banking | Theme: Regional Bank NII Expansion | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.47

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$23.40**
% to Pivot	**0.7%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.47 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.3%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**944k <**
Wk2	**1145k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1846k**
Coil Strength	**48.9% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+6.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.37B**
Float	**143M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**10.5**
Rev Growth	**24.1%**
Short %	**4.6%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$24.14**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $23.40 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (1.5M shares)

Target: $26.50 (14% measured move)
Stop: $22.00 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

Jul 16

Earnings report TODAY (Jul 16) creates binary event risk-untradeable pre-report. RS line NOT at new high. TTM EPS negative despite forward profitability expectations creates execution uncertainty. Wait for post-earnings price action. Conviction: Low.

ACA

Arcosa, Inc.

$144.85

Pivot $146.92 | 1.4% away

RS vs SPY: +22.1%

C EARLY STAGE

$7.11B Cap | 48M Float

Infrastructure Products & Aggregates | Theme: Infrastructure Reshoring Spend | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 8.72

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$146.92**
% to Pivot	**1.4%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**8.72 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.6%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**698k <**
Wk2	**780k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1602k**
Coil Strength	**56.4% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+22.1%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$7.11B**
Float	**48M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**32.4**
Fwd P/E	**28.5**
Rev Growth	**4.4%**
Short %	**2.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$145.50**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $146.92 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (670K shares)

Target: $165.00 (12% measured move)
Stop: $135.00 (base low invalidation)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

REPORTED

Base_tight 8.72 is extremely loose (early consolidation), RS line NOT at new high, no verified earnings catalyst (last reported 76 days ago), and Industrials sector not leading. Vol dry-up exists but setup is weeks away from actionable. Monitor for tightening. Conviction: Low.